

Honor Code and Program Policies

1. Honor Code

General rules of conduct

Participants are required and encouraged to contribute to the enhancement of the experience of all participants and to encourage enthusiasm for learning, intellectual honesty, vigor in debate, and openness and respect for fellow participants.

It is important that all participants feel comfortable to learn and explore during their time on this program. Participants are required to contribute to a respectful learning environment through intellectual honesty, robust debate, openness and respect for fellow participants, teaching team members, and support staff.

By adhering to the following core principles, and by working together, we can foster a respectful learning environment where we improve lives through better education.

As a participant in this program, I agree that I will:

1. Maintain only one user account, and not allow another person to use my login details;
2. Take responsibility for my own learning, while also interacting constructively with my fellow participants, Success Manager, and Learning Facilitator;
3. Treat all Faculty, employees of MIT and GetSmarter, and fellow participants with dignity and respect;
4. Not abuse or otherwise interfere with any member of the MIT or GetSmarter community in any manner that contributes to disrupting their work or to the creation of an intimidating, hostile, or demeaning environment for team members or participants in general;
5. Not plagiarize or engage in any other form of academic dishonesty; and
6. Comply with any reasonable instruction of an authorized MIT or GetSmarter representative.

Discussion forum use

The discussion forums serve as a platform for academic collaboration and aim to enrich the learning experience through dynamic engagement and healthy debate.

GetSmarter retains the right to monitor posts on the discussion forum to ensure that the environment remains constructive and that the integrity of interaction is maintained.

The discussion forums in this program operate on the understanding that participants are free to use the information received, but neither the identity nor the affiliation of the speaker(s), nor that of any other participants, may be revealed outside of the discussion and program environment.

The following content is prohibited on the discussion forums:

1. Content that defames or threatens others;
2. Harassing statements or content that violates the law;
3. Content that discusses illegal activities with the intent to commit them;
4. Content that is not your own, or infringes on another's intellectual property, including, but not limited to, copyrights, trademarks or trade secrets;
5. Content related to partisan political activities;
6. Material that contains obscene (i.e. pornographic) language or images;
7. Advertising or any form of commercial solicitation or promotion, including links to other sites
8. Content that is otherwise unlawful;
9. Intentionally incomplete, misleading or inaccurate content;
10. Violations of the Honor Code.

GetSmarter reserves the right to remove any postings that contravene the above prohibitions.

Sanctions for violations of the Honor Code

If you are found in violation of the Honor Code, you may be subject to one or more of the following actions:

- Receiving a zero for an assignment.
- Having any certificate earned in the program withheld or revoked

- Being unenrolled from a program.
- Having your use of the website terminated.

Additional actions may be taken at the sole discretion of GetSmarter and MIT. No refunds will be issued in the case of any corrective action for such violations. Honor Code violations will be determined at the sole discretion of GetSmarter and the University. You will be notified if a determination has been made that you have violated this Honor Code and you will be informed of the corresponding action to be taken as a result of the violation.

2. Program Policies

Intellectual Property and Confidentiality

We highly recommend that you avoid disclosing any confidential information in your assignments and discussion forum posts (including intellectual property and "third party" confidential information, such as information about your employer that is not publicly available). You are entirely responsible for ensuring that you do not disclose any information that is protected by confidentiality agreements. We will ensure that all information is treated in accordance with our privacy policy, but we will not sign any separate confidentiality agreements or non-disclosure agreements. Although you are encouraged to draw on real-world experience during the program, it is up to you to remain cognizant of any legal restrictions you may be under.

If, during the program, you disclose or create any intellectual property (for example, trademarks, designs, written materials, know-how and other products of your independent thought, creativity and intellectual effort), you accept all and any risks in relation to disclosure, including the risk that a fellow participant will use this intellectual property without your consent, or that disclosure weakens or erases any legal protections.

We won't use any intellectual property created by you and submitted in, or forming part of, your assignments, other than for internal research and development, program improvement and similar non-commercial purposes, without your written consent.

Maintaining personal information

As a participant, you are responsible for ensuring that your personal information provided upon registration is accurate, complete and valid. This information includes the following:

- First and Last Names
- Billing address

- Residential address
- Delivery address
- Telephone numbers

If you undergo a name change during the presentation of a program, you will be required to communicate this to your Success Manager who will advise you on the process to be followed.

Should any of the above information change at any stage subsequent to the submission of your registration, please contact GetSmarter so that your information may be updated. This is important to ensure the smooth running of your learning journey.

GetSmarter and the university will not accept responsibility for the consequences of incorrect, outdated, invalid or missing participant information.

Participant terms and conditions

The terms and conditions that apply to all participants and govern the use of GetSmarter's products and services as well as your registration for any short program offered in collaboration with GetSmarter can be found on our website.

Academic integrity

Academic integrity refers to the commitment and demonstration of honest and ethical behavior in an academic setting. It includes providing credit to others when using their ideas.

Plagiarism is a form of cheating and is considered a form of academic misconduct.

Plagiarism

Plagiarism can be defined as the intentional or unintentional use of another's work without providing reasonable and appropriate credit to the author or source of the work.

Plagiarism includes, but is not limited to, the use of another's words, ideas, opinions, theories or data.

The matter of plagiarism is nuanced and understanding the different forms it can take will empower you to develop relevant competencies to avoid plagiarizing and produce a high standard of work. As a participant, you need to take responsibility for your own academic work and ensure that you submit work that is your own.

There are several types of plagiarism, including:

- **Direct plagiarism:** This form of plagiarism refers to the direct usage of another's work in your submission. If you directly duplicate material without attributing it (by including in-text and bibliography references), you are committing direct plagiarism.
- **Accidental plagiarism:** While direct plagiarism is an intentional act, accidental plagiarism is unintentional and is a result of failing to properly cite your sources (by including in-text references in your work and full references in the bibliography). Be sure to attribute all sources that you have drawn from.
- **Mosaic plagiarism:** This kind of plagiarism is a result of patching together numerous sources, without citation, to create a unique, if not original, piece of work. It is important to indicate all sources used in both in-text and bibliographic references.
- **Self-plagiarism:** Self-plagiarism refers to the use of material you have previously created, without referencing it. It may seem strange, but if you refer to ideas or arguments from previous assignments that you have submitted, you should reference them and cite yourself, to avoid self-plagiarism.

For more information, read Plagiarism.org's [article](#) on how to avoid plagiarism in your writing.

Rules on plagiarism

With every assessment (such as ongoing projects or activity submissions), you will be required to acknowledge and adhere to the plagiarism declaration.

Plagiarism declaration

1. I know that plagiarism is wrong. Plagiarism is to use another's work and pretend that it is one's own.
2. This assignment is my own work.
3. I have not allowed and will not allow anyone to copy my work with the intention of passing it off as his or her own work.
4. I acknowledge that copying someone else's assignment (or part of it) is wrong and declare that my assignments are my own work.

Consequences of plagiarism

Engaging in plagiarism, be it accidental or intentional, may result in:

- Having marks deducted from your assignment,
- Receiving zero for your assignment,

- Not having a certificate issued to you.

Avoiding plagiarism

Access the link below to view a tool that you can use to help you avoid committing plagiarism in this program. You may consult your Head Learning Facilitator or Success Manager should you have any further queries about plagiarism in this program.

[Avoiding plagiarism tool](#)

Extensions

During the program, you may encounter circumstances that hinder your ability to submit your assignments by the stipulated deadline. In such cases, whether anticipated or unanticipated, you are required to follow the procedures as outlined in this policy.

Reasons and eligibility for extensions

There are two categories of reasons for extensions:

1. Unanticipated

- Illness or health problems
- Bereavement
- Psychological well-being
- Other personal or professional exceptional circumstances
- Emergency circumstances

All requests for extensions that fall into this category must be submitted no later than 48 hours after the assignment deadline.

2. Anticipated

- Birth or adoption of a child
- Cultural or religious reasons
- Work commitments

All requests for extensions that fall into this category must be submitted in advance and no later than 72 hours before the assignment deadline.

Extension procedure

Number of extensions during the program

The number of extensions that may be requested during the program is limited to 1 extension per assessment (i.e., extensions on extensions are not permitted).

Duration of extension

Extensions can be requested for up to 7 days. Please note that for extensions requested in the final module a maximum of 4 days is allowed due to the timeline for grading and release of final results.

Extension request procedure

Requests for extensions may only be submitted via the “Request an extension” button on the Online Campus. If you submit a request via email or discussion groups, you will be requested to submit the same request via the Online Campus.

Please note that a separate extension request must be submitted for **each assessment**, even where the reason for the request is the same.

Automatically granted requests

Extensions will be automatically granted if all of the following conditions are met:

- a) The duration of extension requested is no longer than 7 days;
- b) You have not requested an extension for the same assessment already;

Please note: this also applies to requests made on behalf of a group.

Individually considered requests

If your request does not meet the conditions for automatic approval, it will be forwarded to our extensions team who will make a decision regarding your request within 24 hours. The submission of a request under these circumstances does not guarantee that it will be granted. Discretion will apply in order to ensure manageable impact on your learning journey as well as academic integrity and fairness to all participants.

The outcome of your request will be communicated to you via email. Should your extension be granted, your amended submission deadline will reflect on the Online Campus and your assignment will be due for submission by the new deadline.

Receipt of an extension may cause a delay in receiving your grades.

Please note that no extensions will be granted allowing submission after the deadline of the final module unless exceptional circumstances exist.

Faulty assignment submissions

Regardless of an extension being granted, all assignments must be submitted via the Online Campus. No emailed assignments will be accepted.

As set out in the Honor Code, when submitting an assignment, it is your responsibility to ensure that the assignment file is submitted in good order. If it is identified during grading that a corrupt file or incorrect file format has been submitted, your Success Manager will alert you to this as soon as possible. You are then required to resubmit your assignment via the Online Campus by the deadline stipulated by your Success Manager no more than 24 hours will be provided. Please be advised that submitting an incorrect file format or corrupt file will result in a delay in receiving your grade and feedback for the assignment. Once you have received your grade and feedback, we will not accept any amendments to your assignment.

Result query policy

Should you have a query relating to your grade or assignment feedback, you are required to email your query to your Success Manager within 48 hours of receiving your graded assignment. Please include specifics relating to your query.

Once your Success Manager has received your query, it will be relayed to the teaching team to be addressed. You will receive feedback on your query from your Success Manager within 7 working days of submission.